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TAB 3



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-024-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 8/26/2025**In Control:** Facilities

Authorization to Execute a Joint Powers Agreement with the City of Los Angeles for the Community School Parks Program

Facilities Services Division

Brief Description:

(Authorization to Execute a Joint Powers Agreement with the City of Los Angeles for the Community School Parks Program) Recommends to authorize the Chief Facilities Executive and/or her designee(s) to execute a Joint Powers Agreement (JPA) and related documents with the City of Los Angeles Department of Recreation and Parks (City) for the continued operation and expansion of the Community School Parks (CSPs) Program at various campuses, including the addition of new sites as CSPs.

Action Proposed:

Authorize the Chief Facilities Executive and/or her designee(s) to execute a JPA and any other reasonable instruments with the City for the operation of the CSPs Program at various campuses, and authorization to add new CSPs.

Background:

The City and Los Angeles Unified have a long history of collaborating with one another on common interests via Joint Use and Joint Powers Agreements, permits, licenses and other use agreements. On February 26, 2008, the Board of Education (Board) and the City of Los Angeles City Council adopted companion Resolutions entitled: *"Create School-Community Parks in Partnership with Community Groups and the City of Los Angeles"* in support of making Los Angeles Unified schools available to the community. In 2015, the City of Los Angeles unveiled its Sustainable City pLAn / Green New Deal which established the City of Los Angeles's goal of increasing the percentage of residents living within one-half mile of a park to 65% by 2025, and to 75% by 2035. On February 01, 2017, the Board of Recreation and Park Commissioners (City's Board) approved a CSP Pilot Program to increase park access in park deficient areas in the City of Los Angeles. The City has challenges in meeting this goal due to a lengthy acquisition and development process for new park property and limited funding. The City identified Los Angeles Unified elementary and middle schools in park deficient areas and engaged the Los Angeles Unified in creating a sustainable plan for creating CSPs, schools where the play yards and outdoor facilities of schools are open to the public, students and the community during weekends, school holidays and school vacation periods for recreational use. The City subsequently identified and earmarked funding for this effort to cover Los Angeles Unified's direct costs in assisting with the operation of the CSPs.

On April 18, 2017, the Board approved, and on December 11, 2017, the City and Los Angeles Unified entered into an Agreement for the operation of CSPs (Original Agreement) at four Los Angeles Unified elementary schools in park deficient areas. Under the terms of the Original Agreement, the City hired staff responsible for providing the necessary supervision at the CSPs. The Original Agreement was for a trial period of one year, during which time the City and Los Angeles Unified committed to working together to add school sites and negotiate long term CSP agreements. The one-year trial period ended, however, the City and Los Angeles

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Unified continued operating the CSPs while working on adding programming at the existing CSP sites and working on adding more schools.

On February 19, 2019, the Board approved the extension of the Original Agreement for a period of one year, to commence at the expiration of the Original Agreement on December 11, 2018, with a one-year extension option (Extension Agreement), which the City exercised upon Board approval. The Extension Agreement was set to terminate on December 10, 2020, however, due to the Covid-19 pandemic and related health and safety guidance, Los Angeles Unified ceased all use of school sites by third parties on March 12, 2020, and the CSP program was suspended.

By 2022, Los Angeles Unified began reopening school campuses for third-party use. At that time, the City expressed interest in reactivating the CSP program, this time focusing on middle schools due to their grass fields, which allow for expanded outdoor programming. To quickly relaunch the program, the City initiated use of three middle school sites-Barack Obama Global Preparation Academy, Bethune Middle School, and Northridge Middle School-through Civic Center permits issued by Los Angeles Unified. By 2024, the program had expanded to include 10 CSP sites (Current CSP). (See Exhibit A for the list of Current CSP schools.)

The City has identified and earmarked funding to support the ongoing use of, and the implementation of programming at, the Current CSPs. If at any point during the term of the JPA, as it may be extended, City funding becomes unavailable for the continued operation of one or more of the CSPs, Los Angeles Unified will not have an obligation to continue operating the schools as CSPs. If the City identifies additional funding, the parties may mutually agree to add schools to the CSPs program. Any additional schools will be operated on the same terms and conditions outlined in the JPA.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the action will authorize the Chief Facilities Executive and/or her designee to execute the JPA and any other reasonable instruments for the operation of CSPs.

Board Options and Consequences:

A “Yes” vote by the Board will authorize the Chief Facilities Executive and/or her designee to negotiate and execute the JPA and any other reasonable instruments for the City’s operation of the Current CSPs and the addition of future CSPs with the parties’ mutual agreement and with prior authorization by the City’s Board. The CSPs will continue to provide much needed access to outdoor recreational space for the students of the CSP schools and their surrounding communities during weekends, school holidays and school vacation periods. Los Angeles Unified and the City will continue to work cooperatively in ensuring the safe operation of CSPs.

A “No” vote will prohibit the City from utilizing the earmarked funding, the Current CSPs will cease operation and the students and community that have accessed the Current CSPs will once again find themselves lacking in the use of outdoor space for recreational purposes.

Policy Implications:

This action helps facilitate the Board’s Resolution, adopted on February 26, 2008, to “*Create School-Community Parks in Partnership with Community Groups and the City of Los Angeles.*” Additionally, CSPs is an area for exploration included in the 100 Day Plan as part of the Advocacy Strategy for pursuing education compacts with governmental entities and the initiative supports LAUSD’s Strategic Plan Pillar 2 on Joy and Wellness and Pillar 3 on Engagement and Collaboration.

Budget Impact:

The City will provide funding for the operation of the CSPs. As such, no funding from Los Angeles Unified's General Fund or Bond program funds will be required.

Student Impact:

Students from the schools that have CSPs and those from the surrounding schools who do not have a City park within half a mile of their home now have a safe place to enjoy outdoor recreation and programs.

Equity Impact:

CSPs are located in areas that lack sufficient park space. If the City identifies additional funding and schools in areas that can greatly benefit from opening new CSPs, Los Angeles Unified will work with the City to ensure the new CSPs are open for the benefit of the students and the community.

Issues and Analysis:

Staff has reached an agreement with the City on the material terms of the operation and maintenance of the CSPs as follows:

1. The JPA will be for a term of 10 years, with two options, each option being for five years. If each option is exercised, the JPA will have a duration of a total of 20 years.
2. Operation of the Current CSPs and/or any new CSP is contingent on the City providing funding. If the City does not have sufficient funding, the City will cease operating the CSPs, and additional schools will not be identified for the program. Furthermore, if City funding becomes unavailable at any point in time, Los Angeles Unified will not have an obligation to continue operating the schools as CSPs.
3. Use of the CSPs will be open to the public free of charge. It is expected that all types of outdoor activities will conform generally to those which are permitted under a Civic Center Permit; any additional proposed activities are subject to review and approval by Los Angeles Unified.
4. The play yards and outdoor facilities at CSP schools will be open to the public, including students and the community, during weekends, school holidays and school vacation periods for recreational use.
5. The City is responsible for all costs associated with the operation, maintenance, staffing and security of CSPs. This includes, but is not limited to, the opening and closing of the facilities, including the restrooms, which will be opened and closed on an as-needed basis.
6. Los Angeles Unified will provide custodial support, at City's expense, to ensure the schools are ready for instruction after the operation of the CSPs.
7. The City is responsible for operating, monitoring and supervising the public, students and community and the City-operated programs for the duration of the time the CSPs are open.
8. The City will assume all liability during the operation of the CSPs.
9. The City will implement free or minimal fee programs at CSPs that will benefit the public, students and community of the CSPs.

10. Provided the City has secured funding and received the City's Board approval, at the City's request, and with Los Angeles Unified's approval, additional Los Angeles Unified schools may be added to the CSPs program. Any added schools will be operated on the same terms and conditions outlined in the JPA. If the City identifies additional schools, the City and the Los Angeles Unified will engage the schools' administration and maintenance staff to assess the feasibility to ensure operating a CSP at the school will not negatively impact the school's operation.

Attachments:

Exhibit A - Community School Parks

Submitted:

07/31/25

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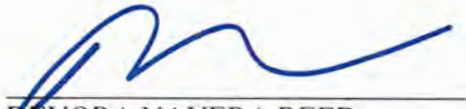
RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


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Superintendent

APPROVED BY:


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☒ Approved as to form.

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PRESENTED BY:


ISSAM DAHDUL
Director of Facilities
Planning and Development
Facilities Services Division

Exhibit A
Community School Parks

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#	Board District	Region	School
1	1	South	Barack Obama Global Preparation Academy
2	1	West	Pio Pico Middle School
3	2	West	Leo Politi Elementary
4	3	North	Northridge Middle School
5	4	North	Garden Grove Elementary
6	4	West	Open Charter Magnet
7	5	West	Harvard Elementary
8	5	West	Ramona Elementary
9	6	North	Camellia Avenue Elementary
10	7	South	Mary McLeod Bethune Middle School